

L A S T S E E N

Case One: Widow's Point — voicemail recording scripts (7 cues)

- Record clean and dry: no phone EQ, no beep — the phone-line filter and leading beep are applied at integration so all cues match. Format .m4a, mono. Target lengths ± 5 seconds.
- Spoken words must match these scripts word-for-word — the app shows the transcript beside the audio. Direction, pauses, and breaths are yours.
- Casting: Mom (60s, warm) · Dae (late 20s, any gender) · Carol (40s–60s) · Marcus (mid-30s) · Eli (late 20s–30s, easy warmth).
- Priority: 5, 1, 2 (Mom carries the game), then 7 (Eli), 3, 6, 4. Two more cues (Dad, Mom N10) arrive with the noise pass — don't record them yet.

1 • Mom

vm-mom-oct2.m4a · 1:12 target

The baseline “before” recording: Mom happy. Wandering but bright; she repeats herself a little. Cozy, not yet worrying. Long thinking pauses stretch this to 1:12.

CLUE LINE: “twelve years this fall” must be clearly audible — it is a password source. Don't rush it; don't emphasize it either.

“Quinn, honey, it's your mother. I was thinking about the wisteria at Alder Street — twelve years this fall since we lost that house, can you believe it. Your father never did fix the gate. Anyway. The girl on the radio said rain. Call me when you're off, don't forget to eat something.”

Direction: Smile through “can you believe it.” A small sad breath on “your father,” then briskly past it — she's practiced at stepping over that hole.

2 • Mom

vm-mom-oct11.m4a · 0:31 target

The night before. Mom notices what nobody else did. Quieter and slower than #1 — her lucid register. It should unsettle in hindsight.

“You sounded far away today, sweetheart. Not the phone kind of far away. The other kind. You get that from him, you know. Call me back.”

Direction: “The other kind” almost a whisper. No melodrama; she is stating a fact she has seen before.

3 • Dae

vm-dae-oct13.m4a · 0:22 target

3 AM, the day after the car was found. Genuinely crying — messy, angry, young. Recorded too close to the mic. Cuts off mid-thought.

“Pick up. Pick up pick up pick up. Tell me you didn’t — you don’t get to make me the plant person, Quinn, that was a JOKE —”

Direction: “JOKE” breaks upward, furious and pleading at once. Hard stop right after — the app adds the call-ended click.

4 • Carol (Halloway front office)

vm-hr.m4a · 0:26 target

An office voice performing a script she is ashamed of. Starts corporate, collapses into human. The doubled apology at the end is real.

“Ms. Mercer, this is Carol from the front office. Mr. Halloway asked me to remind you that company records and login credentials are company property, and, um — given the circumstances I’m so sorry to be leaving this message at all. Please disregard. I’m sorry.”

Direction: The “um” is where the script runs out. Speed up slightly through “please disregard” — she wants off this call.

5 • Mom

vm-mom-oct15.m4a · 0:47 target

THE voicemail — three days after Quinn “died,” and Mom thanks her for flowers. Play it completely straight: to Mom, nothing is wrong. Warmth with a thin crack of loneliness at the end. Never spooky.

“Thank you for the flowers, honey. Lilies, like the fair. Though I told the delivery girl at the door, my Quinn always sends yellow ones — she laughed. People laugh at me now. The card was nice. You and your little codes. Call me back, everyone here keeps using the wrong voice.”

Direction: “People laugh at me now” is light, almost amused — which makes it land harder. “You and your little codes” with real affection. Last line slower, smaller.

6 • Marcus Halloway

vm-marcus.m4a · 0:29 target

Added in v2 (Night 6). Mid-30s, private-school polish fraying in real time. Starts controlled, cracks in the middle. The unfinished “For —” is the entire performance: he almost says “for you” and can’t.

“Quinn. It’s — you know who it is. My father had his consultant in the office for an hour today and your name came through the door twice. Whatever you copied — I need to know it’s somewhere safe. Not for him. For — just. Call me back. Not the office line.”

Direction: Pace quickens through “came through the door twice” — he’s walking somewhere private. Long breath before “Not for him.”

7 • Eli Soto

vm-eli.m4a · 0:41 target

Added in v2 (Night 7) — the hardest one. Late 20s, easy warmth, half-shouting over wind and engine. THE POINT: he is not scared. The water complaint is offhand, between dinner plans and Sunday at her mother’s. Record clean; wind/deck ambience in post. Bracketed sounds are production notes, not lines.

“Rosita. Don’t cook tonight, I’ll bring— [wind] —they’ve got us pulling cages out of seven today. water smells like a battery, I’m not — [inaudible] — Ramos says the notice came down last week and the office said pull anyway, so. [pause] Tell your mother we’ll come Sunday. Love you.”

Direction: “Love you” thrown away, routine, already turning back to work. That’s what makes it unbearable on the second listen.

Drop finished files in assets/audio/ with the exact filenames. Post at integration: low-pass ≈3.4 kHz + light compression, leading beep, trailing click on cue 3, wind/deck ambience under cue 7.